

TRUSTMRR • 1,000-STARTUP DATASET • FROZEN 30 JUL 2026

Inside the Indie Economy

What 1,000 real, revenue-verified startups reveal about how bootstrapped businesses actually grow, earn, and get sold

A data story for Masters' Union

First, what are we actually looking at?

TrustMRR is a public directory where founders connect their real payment processor (Stripe, RevenueCat, Paddle...) to prove their revenue — no vanity screenshots, no rounding up. This dataset is a frozen snapshot of 1,000 such verified startups, each with 29 data points on revenue, growth, audience, and more.

1K

Startups tracked

Real companies, real founders

29

Data fields each

Revenue, growth, pricing, audience

9

Payment providers

Stripe, RevenueCat, Paddle & more

50+

Countries represented

A genuinely global sample

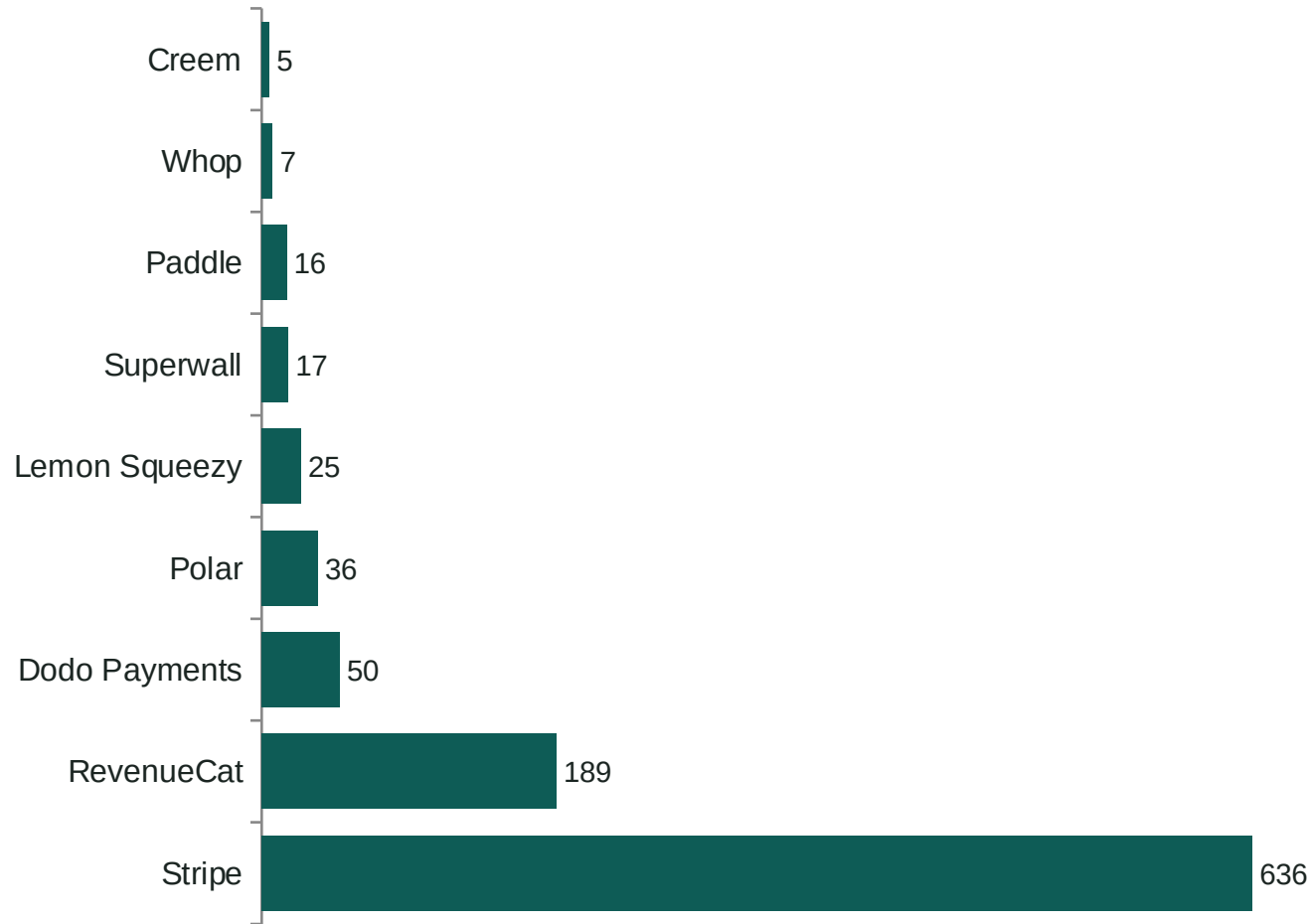


Why this matters for a founder-in-training

Unlike VC-funded unicorn stories, this is the indie/bootstrapped internet — small teams, real revenue, no hype. It's a far more honest picture of how most businesses actually behave.

What's actually verifying these numbers

Payment processor connected by each startup to prove its revenue (top 9, of 1,000)



Stripe is the default rail

63.6% of all startups (636 of 1,000) verify through Stripe — the closest thing this economy has to a universal standard.

A distinct in-app tier

RevenueCat (189 startups) mostly represents mobile subscription apps — a meaningfully different business model from web SaaS.

A long, fragmented tail

7 more processors split the remaining ~10% — Dodo, Polar, Lemon Squeezy and others serving niche or indie-first billing needs.

The ecosystem, at a glance

Four numbers that frame everything that follows

\$13.47M

Combined monthly recurring
revenue

across all 1,000 startups

\$133.75M

Combined trailing 12-month
revenue

real, processor-verified dollars

500,597

Active paying subscriptions

held across the whole sample

1,000

Independent businesses

spanning 50+ countries

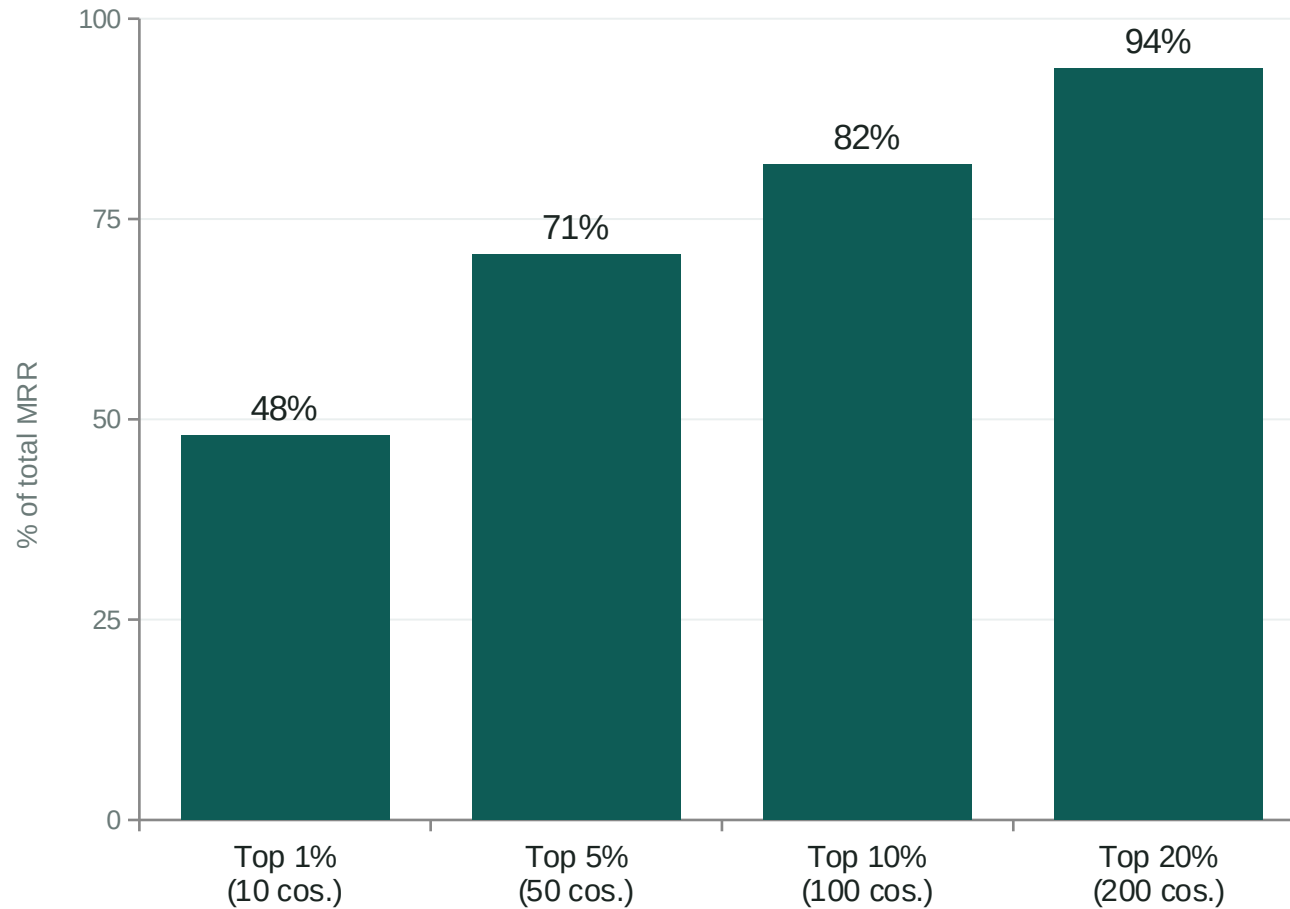
\$

But here's the twist: the **average** startup earns **\$13,472/month** in MRR — but the **typical (median)** one earns only **\$282/month**. A handful of breakout winners are pulling the average way up.

This gap is the whole story of the next slide.

It's a winner-take-most economy

Share of total monthly recurring revenue captured by the top slice of startups



The top 1%

Just 10 startups hold nearly half of all revenue in the sample.

The long tail

The bottom 80% of startups — 800 companies — share only 6.2% of total MRR.

Sound familiar?

This mirrors the power law VCs chase in equity portfolios — except here it plays out in organic, bootstrapped revenue.

Meet the top of the leaderboard

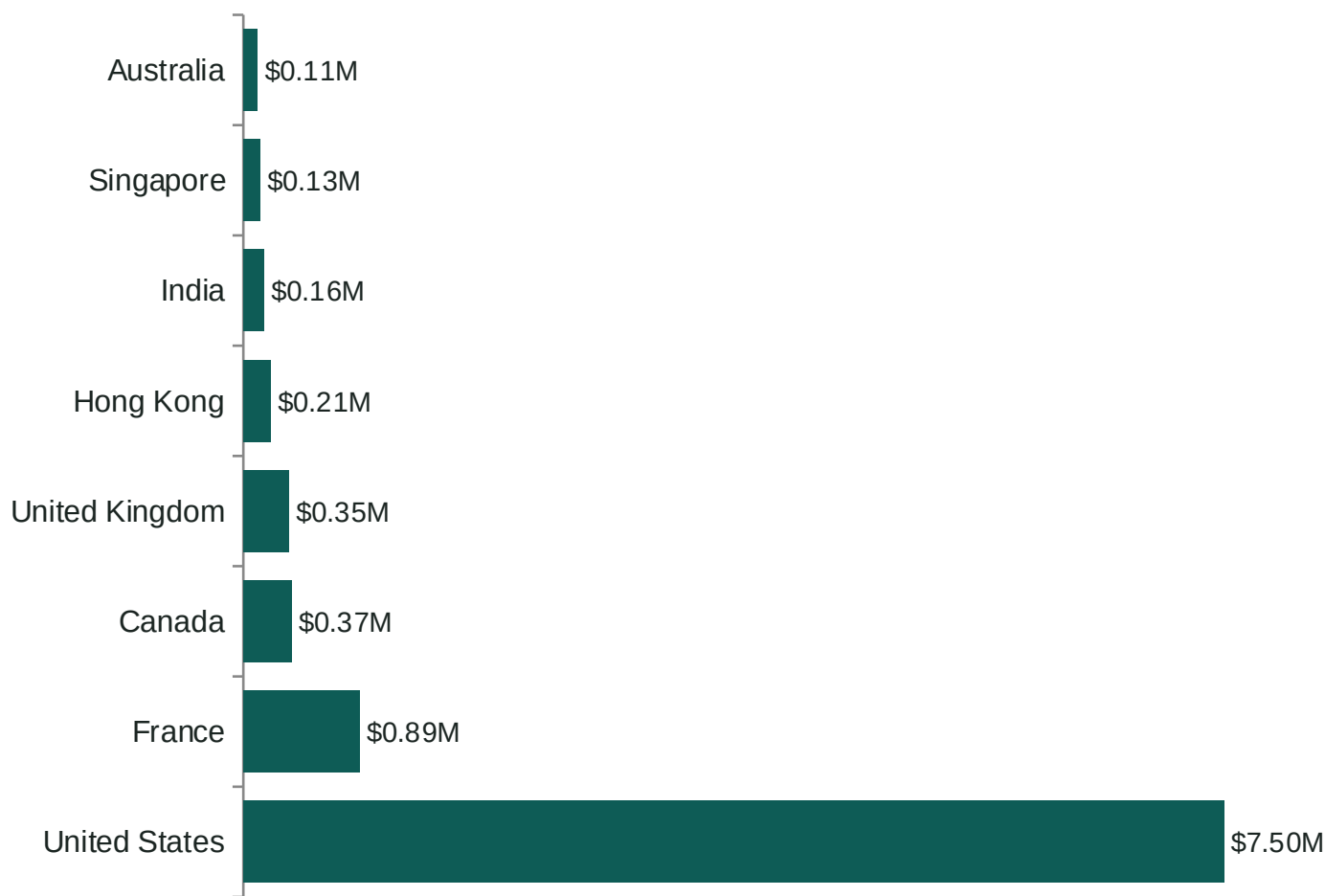
The 6 highest-earning startups by monthly recurring revenue (named entries)

			MRR (monthly)	30-day growth
01	Stan	Creator commerce · US	\$3.57M	+0.4%
02	GojiberryAI	AI · US	\$494.7K	+23.6%
03	Rezi	AI (resume tech) · US	\$259.7K	-4.9%
04	Kibu	Education · US	\$234.3K	+52.8%
05	Cometly	Analytics · US	\$207.6K	+3.0%
06	1Lookup	SaaS · US	\$207.1K	-7.5%

Note: two anonymized “Stealth Company” entries (undisclosed identity, \$364K & \$747K MRR) also rank in the true top 10 but are omitted here for clarity.

Where the indie economy lives

Total monthly recurring revenue by country (top 8)



US dominates by value

258 US startups hold \$7.5M in MRR — over half the entire dataset — averaging \$29K MRR each.

France, a surprising #2

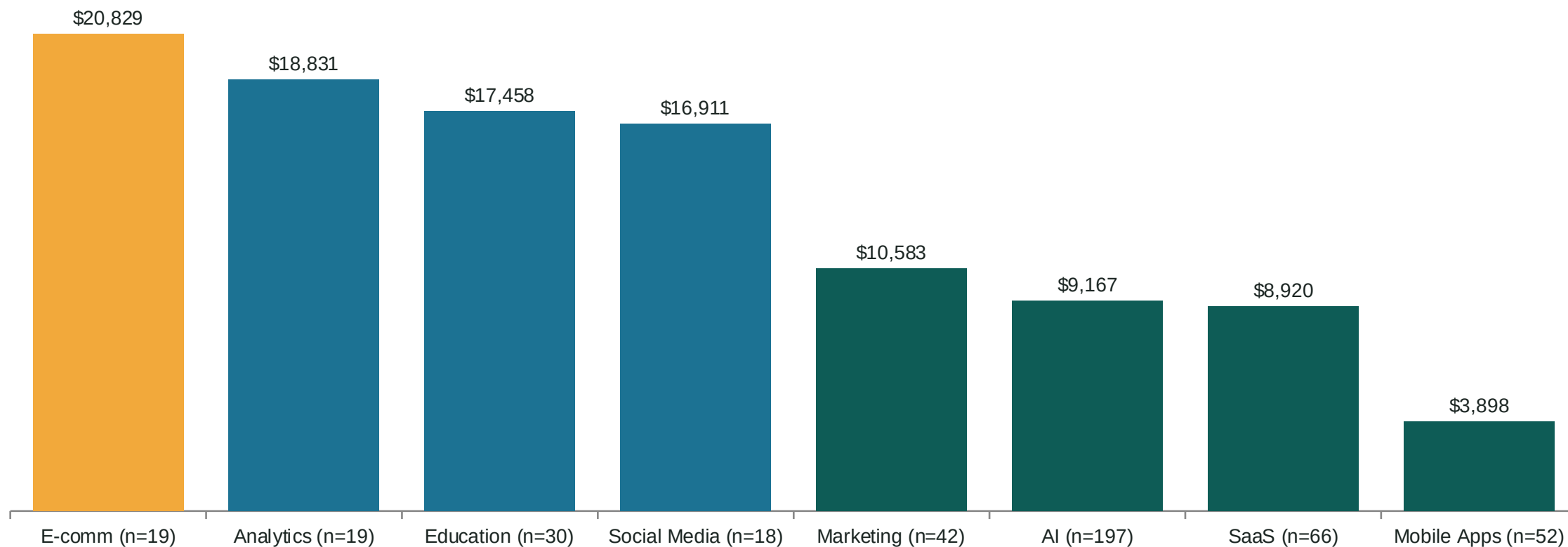
79 French startups (2nd-highest count) generate a modest \$894K combined — smaller average deals.

India: high volume, low value

59 Indian startups (3rd-highest count) average just \$2,655 MRR each — early-stage, pre-monetization.

AI has the crowd. It doesn't have the crown.

Average MRR per startup, by category (categories with 15+ startups)



197 of 1,000 startups (nearly 1 in 5) are labeled AI — the single most crowded category. Yet its average MRR (\$9.2K) trails **E-commerce, Analytics, Education and Social Media** — categories with far fewer, but more monetized, players.

B2B pays more per customer. B2C pays more per visitor.

B2B

255 startups

\$13,150

average MRR per startup

\$12.03

average revenue per visitor

B2C

401 startups

\$5,102

average MRR per startup

\$26.01

average revenue per visitor

Reading this: B2B startups land bigger, stickier accounts — 2.6× the average MRR of B2C. But B2C startups extract more than 2× the revenue from every visitor who lands on their site, since B2C monetizes on-site conversion directly rather than sales-led deals. (Visitor-level data is a smaller sub-sample of ~120 startups — directional, not exhaustive.)

The fastest movers of the last 30 days

Named startups with 50+ subscribers, ranked by 30-day MRR growth

+239.5%

LLM Gateway

AI · US

\$47.2K MRR

+458.6%

Hong Xuan Kow

AI · US

\$20.3K MRR

+384.5%

Kickly – Pronos IA

Games · FR

\$10.2K MRR

+100.0%

SetSmart

SaaS

\$15.7K MRR

+91.2%

overrank SEO

Marketing · US

\$9.5K MRR

+139.1%

Chartvio

AI · US

\$1.1K MRR

A word of caution: a handful of unnamed “Stealth Company” entries show even larger swings (one +12,983% on a low prior base) — spectacular percentages on a small starting number can be misleading. Growth on real scale, like LLM Gateway's, is the more durable signal.

1 in 4 of these startups is already for sale

Distribution of asking prices among the 262 startups listed for sale



26.2%

of all 1,000 startups are listed for sale (262 total)

\$35,000

median asking price — most listings are small, accessible deals

2.3×

median revenue multiple founders are asking for

So what should a founder take away?

1

Expect a power law, not a bell curve.

Ten startups hold ~48% of all MRR. Median success looks nothing like average success — plan for a long, thin runway before any breakout.

2

Category crowding $\neq$ category profitability.

AI has the most founders (197) but not the best average unit economics. Less-hyped categories like E-commerce and Analytics monetize better per business.

3

Know which lever you're pulling.

B2B wins on deal size; B2C wins on conversion efficiency. Pick a monetization model that matches your actual customer, not the trend.

4

Geography still shapes outcomes.

The same idea monetizes very differently in the US vs. emerging markets — factor this into TAM and pricing assumptions early.

5

Building to sell is now mainstream.

A quarter of indie startups are already listed for sale at a median 2.3 $\times$ revenue — exits at modest scale are a real, common outcome.



Thank you

Questions, pushback, and “what about...” are all welcome.

Source: trustmrr.com • 1,000-startup dataset frozen 30 Jul 2026